



Consumer Healthcare

PROCESS GUIDE

Retail Customer Onboarding Guide

Process Guide | Opella Europe | Commercial Operations

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1.2	01 May 2025	A. Kovacs	Section 5 (System Account Setup) updated to clarify process for accounts transitioning from Sanofi. New checklist in Appendix A. EDI setup timelines updated (Section 6).
1.1	15 Jan 2025	A. Kovacs	Interim update: credit assessment requirements aligned to Credit Management Policy OPS-EU-FIN-POL-002 v1.2.
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1. Introduction

This guide describes the end-to-end process for onboarding a new retail or pharmacy customer to Opella Europe. It covers every stage from initial commercial agreement through to first live order, and provides the Account Manager and Customer Service team with a single reference for what needs to happen, in what sequence, and who is responsible at each stage.

A new customer is not ready to place orders until all stages in this guide are complete. Placing an order before onboarding is complete creates risk: the customer may not have a credit limit set, the system record may be incomplete, and the order confirmation process may not function correctly. The CS Team Lead must confirm account readiness before the Account Manager communicates a go-live date to the customer.

1.1 Audience

- Account Managers: responsible for initiating the process, providing commercial information, and coordinating customer-side requirements.
- Customer Service Team Lead: responsible for system account setup and CS team readiness.
- Credit Controller: responsible for credit assessment and initial limit setting.
- Opella Digital: responsible for EDI setup (where applicable).

1.2 New Account vs. Migrated Account

This guide applies to two distinct scenarios. The process is similar in both cases, but there are important differences in the system setup and credit assessment steps:

Scenario	Description	Key Differences
New Account	A customer with no prior trading history with Opella or Sanofi.	Full credit assessment required. No pre-existing system record. Longer onboarding timeline (typically 3-4 weeks).
Migrated / Transitioning Account	A customer previously served by Sanofi that is transitioning to direct Opella trading.	Credit assessment may reference Sanofi trading history. System record may already exist but must be reviewed and updated. EDI connection may already be live (but may be TSA-managed).

2. Onboarding Stages Overview

A new retail or pharmacy account must complete the following stages before it is ready to place its first live order. The CS Team Lead tracks progress against these stages using the checklist in Appendix A.

Stage	Activity	Lead	Typical Duration
1	Commercial Agreement and KYC	Account Manager	1-2 weeks
2	Credit Application and Assessment	Credit Controller	3-5 business days
3	System Account Setup	CS Team Lead	1-2 business days

4	EDI / Electronic Trading Setup (if applicable)	Opella Digital	4-6 weeks (may run parallel to stages 1-3)
5	First Order Hypercare	CS Representative (supervised by CS TL)	First 3 orders
6	Account Activation	CS Team Lead	1 business day

SEQUENCING NOTE

Stages 1, 2, and 3 must be completed in sequence. Stage 4 (EDI setup) can run in parallel with stages 1-3 and does not gate the account going live - the account can begin trading on manual/email orders while EDI setup completes. Stage 5 begins with the first live order.

3. Stage 1 - Commercial Agreement and KYC

3.1 Commercial Agreement Prerequisites

Before the onboarding process starts, the Account Manager must confirm that the following are in place:

- A signed commercial agreement (framework agreement, terms of trade, or purchase order terms) accepted by both parties.
- Agreed price list reference applicable to the account.
- Agreed account tier (Tier 1, 2, or 3 per Credit Management Policy OPS-EU-FIN-POL-002) and indicative credit limit expectation.
- Agreed standard payment terms (or Finance Director approval for any deviation from standard terms).
- Designated order contact and invoice contact at the customer.
- Confirmed delivery address(es) and any specific delivery requirements.

3.2 Know Your Customer (KYC) Requirements

Opella's legal and compliance requirements mandate KYC screening for all new trading accounts. The Account Manager initiates KYC screening by submitting the customer's legal entity details (registered name, company number, registered address, VAT number) to Finance/Compliance.

KYC clearance is a prerequisite for credit assessment (Stage 2) and system account creation (Stage 3). Onboarding may not proceed until KYC clearance is confirmed in writing by Finance/Compliance.

4. Stage 2 - Credit Assessment and Limit Setting

The Account Manager submits the Credit Application Form to the Credit Controller once KYC clearance is confirmed. The full credit assessment process is governed by the Credit Management Policy (OPS-EU-FIN-POL-002, Section 3).

The Account Manager should indicate the commercial context for the requested credit limit: expected annual order value, typical order size and frequency, and any commitments made to the customer about credit terms. The Credit Controller will use this information as context but the final limit is set independently under the Credit Management Policy.

FOR MIGRATED / TRANSITIONING ACCOUNTS

If the customer previously traded with Sanofi, the Credit Controller may request the Sanofi trading record as a reference. This information may be available from the Sanofi TSA. However, the Opella credit limit is set independently under Opella governance. The Sanofi credit limit does not automatically apply to the Opella account.

Account Managers must NOT advise customers that their previous Sanofi credit limit will carry over to Opella without written Credit Controller confirmation.

5. Stage 3 - System Account Setup

5.1 Account Creation Responsibility

The CS Team Lead is responsible for creating and configuring the new customer account in our systems. Account creation must not be delegated to a CS Representative for new accounts. The CS Team Lead must personally verify that all mandatory fields are correctly populated before the account is made available for order entry.

5.2 Account Creation Process

1. Receive written confirmation from the Credit Controller of the approved credit limit and agreed payment terms. Do not create the account without this confirmation.
2. Create the customer record in our systems, populating all mandatory fields as listed in Section 5.3. The account must be created in all systems that are used for customer management and order processing. Ensure consistency of data across all systems.
3. Attach the signed commercial agreement and the Credit Controller's credit approval to the account record.
4. Configure the account's price list, payment terms, MOQ settings, and delivery address(es) to match the agreed commercial terms.
5. Flag the account as 'New - Hypercare' to trigger the additional validation checks in Section 7 for the first three orders.
6. Notify the Account Manager and CS team that the account is created and ready for order entry. Confirm the account number and any relevant notes for the CS team.

5.3 Mandatory Account Fields

Field	Source	Notes
Customer Legal Name	KYC documentation	Must match legal entity exactly.
Customer Trading Name	Commercial Agreement	If different from legal name.
SAP Account Number	System-generated	Confirm correct number range for account type.
Company Registration Number	KYC documentation	
VAT Registration Number	KYC documentation	Required for invoice compliance.
Account Tier	Credit Controller	Tier 1 / 2 / 3 per Credit Management Policy.
Credit Limit	Credit Controller written approval	Enter exactly as stated in Credit Controller approval. Do not adjust.
Payment Terms	Credit Controller / Commercial Agreement	Must match agreed terms. Finance Director approval needed for deviations.
Price List Reference	Account Manager	Confirm correct price list version.
Primary Delivery Address	Commercial Agreement	Verify postcode and country code formatting.
Order Contact Name & Email	Account Manager	Used for order confirmation dispatch.

Invoice Contact Name & Email	Account Manager	May differ from order contact.
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5.4 Migrated / Transitioning Account Setup

For customers that were previously served by Sanofi and have a pre-existing record in our systems from the carve-out migration, the CS Team Lead must review the existing record rather than creating a new one. A duplicate record must not be created.

The CS Team Lead must verify that all fields in the existing record are accurate and up to date, paying particular attention to: credit limit (must reflect the Opella-approved limit, not the inherited Sanofi figure), payment terms (may have been updated for the Opella commercial relationship), and delivery addresses (confirm these are still valid for the Opella supply point). Any discrepancies must be corrected before the account is activated for Opella order entry.

6. Stage 4 - EDI and Electronic Trading Setup

Stage 4 applies only to accounts that require EDI connectivity. If the account will trade via manual and email channels only, Stage 4 is not required and the onboarding moves directly to Stage 5 (Hypercare).

EDI setup is managed by Opella Digital. The Account Manager notifies Opella Digital as early as possible in the onboarding process - EDI setup typically requires 4 to 6 weeks from the date technical scoping is agreed. Delays in notifying Opella Digital will delay the go-live date.

6.1 EDI Scoping Requirements

The Account Manager must provide Opella Digital with the following:

- Customer's EDI provider or VAN (Value Added Network) name and contact.
- Required message types (ORDERS, ORDRSP, INVOIC, DESADV).
- Communication protocol (AS2, SFTP, or VAN routing).
- Customer's GLN (Global Location Number) and buyer/supplier codes.
- Expected go-live date and any customer-side testing requirements.
- For migrated accounts: current EDI connection details (if any), including whether the connection is currently managed by Sanofi Shared Services under the TSA (see EDI Integration Register OPS-EU-IT-REG-001).

6.2 EDI Testing

Before an EDI connection goes live, Opella Digital must complete a minimum of three successful end-to-end test cycles for each message type in scope. Test results must be confirmed in writing by both Opella Digital and the customer's EDI team before live orders are accepted via EDI.

The Account Manager is responsible for coordinating the customer's participation in EDI testing. Opella Digital will not sign off an EDI connection as live-ready without confirmed test results from the customer side.

7. Stage 5 - First Order Hypercare

Hypercare applies to the first three orders placed by any new account. The CS Representative processes these orders with additional validation steps, supervised by the CS Team Lead.

Hypercare Validation Step	When	Standard Process
Confirm order details directly with the customer's designated order contact before processing (in addition to standard receipt procedure).	Before SAP order entry.	No (standard process accepts written order as received).
Confirm delivery address against account record AND against the customer's confirmation.	At order entry.	No (standard process checks SAP record only).
Credit Controller verbal confirmation that credit limit is sufficient before order entry (in addition to standard SAP check).	Before SAP order entry.	No (standard process uses SAP check only).

CS Team Lead personal review of the order Before issue of No (standard process: CS Rep confirmation before issue. confirmation. issues directly).

After three successful orders with no errors or customer queries, the CS Team Lead removes the 'Hypercare' flag from the account and it moves to standard processing. The CS Team Lead must document the transition in the account record.

8. Stage 6 - Account Activation Confirmation

Once Stages 1-5 are complete, the CS Team Lead confirms account activation by sending a written confirmation to the Account Manager. The confirmation must include:

- SAP account number.
- Confirmed credit limit and payment terms.
- Order channels available (manual, email, EDI if applicable).
- CS Representative assigned as the primary contact for the account.
- Any account-specific notes relevant to order processing.

The Account Manager may then communicate the go-live date and account details to the customer. The Account Manager must not communicate go-live to the customer before receiving the CS Team Lead's written activation confirmation.

Appendix A: New Account Onboarding Checklist

This checklist is used by the CS Team Lead to track onboarding progress. It must be completed and filed before account activation is confirmed.

#	Item	Responsibility	Complete
1.1	Signed commercial agreement received and filed.	Account Manager	
1.2	Agreed price list version confirmed.	Account Manager	
1.3	KYC clearance received from Finance/Compliance.	Finance/Compliance	
2.1	Credit Application Form submitted to Credit Controller.	Account Manager	
2.2	Credit assessment completed and limit confirmed in writing.	Credit Controller	
3.1	Customer record created / reviewed in all systems.	CS Team Lead	
3.2	Credit limit set exactly per Credit Controller approval.	CS Team Lead	
3.3	Payment terms, price list, MOQ, delivery address configured.	CS Team Lead	
3.4	Account flagged as 'New - Hypercare' in system.	CS Team Lead	
4.1	EDI scoping information submitted to Opella Digital (if applicable).	Account Manager	N/A if no EDI
4.2	EDI testing completed and signed off (if applicable).	Opella Digital	N/A if no EDI
5.1	First 3 orders processed under hypercare with no issues.	CS Rep / CS TL	
6.1	Account activation confirmation sent to Account Manager.	CS Team Lead	